Botanical description of *Allium cepa*

(In APG classification, *Allium cepa* is placed under the family Amaryllidaceae)

Habit: Perennial herb with bulb.

Root: Fibrous adventitious root system

Stem: Underground bulb

Leaf: A cluster of radical leaves emerges from the underground bulb, cylindrical and fleshy having sheathy leaf bases with parallel venation.

Inflorescence: Scapigerous i.e. the inflorescence axis (peduncle) arising from the ground bearing a cluster of flowers at its apex. Pedicels are of equal length, arising from the apex of the peduncle which brings all flowers at the same level.

Flower: Small, white, bracteate, ebracteolate, pedicellate, complete, trimerous, actinomorphic and hypogynous. Flowers are protandrous.

Perianth: Tepals 6, white, arranged in two whorls of three each, syntepalous showing valvate aestivation.

Androecium: Stamens 6, arranged in two whorls of three each, epitepalous, apostamenous /free and opposite to tepals. Anthers dithecous, basifixed, introse, and dehiscing longitudinally.

Gynoecium: Tricarpellary and syncarpous. Ovary superior, trilocular with two ovules in each locule on axile placentation. Style simple, slender with simple stigma.

Fruit: A loculicidal capsule.

Seed: Endospermous

Floral Formula:

$$\mathbf{Br.,Ebrl.,\oplus,\female,P_{(3+3)}\ A_{3+3},\underline{G}_{(3)}}$$

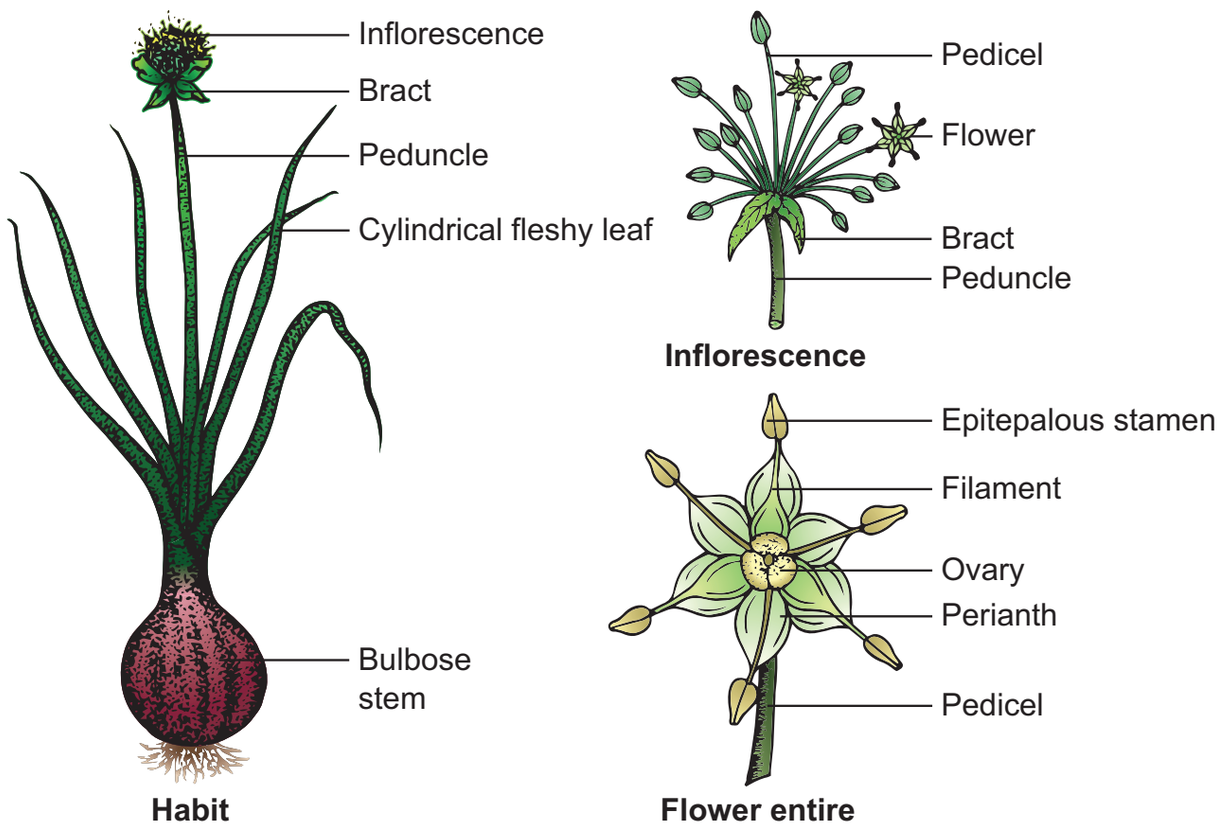


Figure 5.18: *Allium cepa*

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